

Tax that!

Canadian music lovers are in for a bit of a shock and surprise. The Copyright Board of Canada has decided to tax all hard drive-based digital music players to appease a long-standing grouse of musicians, song

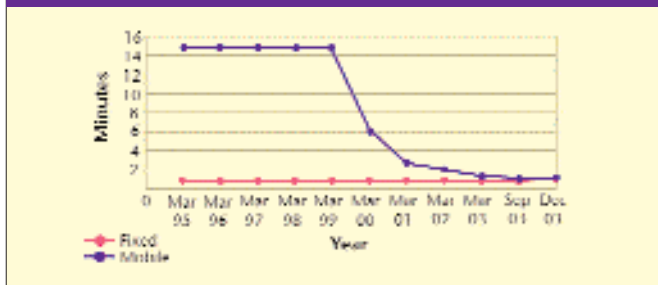


writers and record labels who are affected by the distribution of copyrighted music over P2P networks. And yes, the tax—as much as 25 Canadian dollars—will also be applicable on blank CDs and tapes, all of which will be passed to consumers.

MP3 player manufacturers such as Apple, Dell and HP are fighting this regulation, and retailers such as Wal-Mart Stores and Best Buy are joining up. Their argument relies on a stipulation in the Canadian regulation, which apparently allows for personal downloads over P2P networks—of even copyrighted material. Ironically, uploading copyrighted material is absolutely illegal! This new twist has all the makings of a face-off, with the Canadian Recording Industry Association claiming that downloading copyrighted material is illegal. It plans to challenge the decision, as well as hunt down file swappers in Canada.

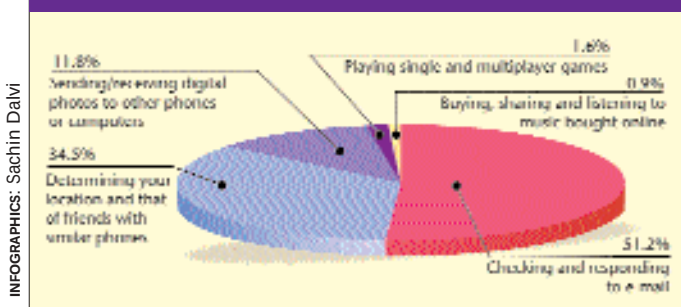
statattack

Call charges for 400 mins of use per month



Source: TRAI

Services most accessed from hand-held devices



Source: Brightmail Inc

No WMA for HP's iPod

The HP iPod will not be able to play WMA files, belying reports that it was working with Apple to get WMA compatibility. This effectively means that all HP branded iPods will still only be able to play Apple's copy-protected secure format, based on the AAC (Advanced Audio Coding) format.

The iPod is linked to Apple's iTunes online music service, which, according to Apple, accounts for 70 per cent of all online music sales. While HP iPod consumers may not currently be able to hear their tunes in the WMA format, industry analysts say that it's possible that HP may work toward a technical fix to make WMAs playable. HP and Apple have strongly denied this so far.

Script your own dreams

In their heyday, the Everly Brothers sang, "All I have to do is dream". Japan's Taraka Co perhaps took inspiration from that song to create their latest machine—a machine that creates custom dreams!

The Yumemi Kobo or 'dream workshop' looks at photos of what you want to dream of, lets you record a story line, and then you sleep.

Voice recordings, lights, music and smells direct users during REM (Rapid Eye Movement)—the period of sleep when humans dream. You are woken gently with light resembling sunlight, so that you can remember your dreams.

Taraka Co also made the Bowlingual and Meowlingual devices, which translate barks and meows from your pets.

redalert

W32/Swen@MM

Also called I-Worm.Swen (AVP), W32/Gibe.e@MM and Win32.HLLM.Gibe.2, this worm spreads via e-mail, network shares, KaZaA and IRC. It terminates various anti-virus and security applications, and contains its own SMTP engine. It copies itself to the Windows folder using a random name, and modifies various registry keys, disables regedit.exe and kills applications. Visit <http://us.mcafee.com/virusInfo/default.asp?id=helpCenter&hcName=swen&cid=9060> for more information.

Trojan.Xombe

This new Trojan—also known as Downloader-GJ and Troj/Dloader-L—is spreading over the Internet through e-mail. The 'From' address is windowsupdate@microsoft.com, with the subject, 'Windows XP Service Pack 1 (Express) - Critical Update'. The message body poses as an update notification from Microsoft, with the security update as the attachment. The 4,096 byte attachment is called 'winxp_sp1.exe'. When executed, it downloads another program 'Mssvc-A', which uses your computer to launch DDos attacks against Web sites. Microsoft says that it does not send security updates as attachments. Visit <http://securityresponse.symantec.com/avcenter/venc/data/trojan.xombe.html> for a patch.

snapshot

American music fans paid for, and downloaded, 30 million tracks in 2003

Source: CNET News

■ Penn State University, USA, links with Napster to offer students legitimate music downloads ■ IBM to hire 15,000 new employees... many outside the US